

UI / UX DESIGN SPRINT

RULEBOOK

A six-phase, six-hour product-design sprint. Read this before you register.

11 SEPTEMBER · 5–11 PM

ONLINE · SINGLE 6-HOUR ROUND



Dear participants

This rulebook is essential for ensuring a fair and successful experience for all. By thoroughly reading and understanding these guidelines, you will help maintain the event's integrity and ensure equal opportunities for all. Please take the time to review this document carefully.

Carnival 8.0's UI/UX competition runs on a structured product-design pipeline. Every team works through six phases — understand, research, plan, design, tidy up, and hand off — inside a single 6-hour window.

WHY IT IS BUILT THIS WAY

The goal is to make sure every participant practices how professional UI/UX work actually happens, not just how to make one screen look polished.

Each phase has its own time limit and its own required output, so how you work is judged alongside the final design.

6 phases	6 hours, one sitting	1–3 members per team
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Prize pool

CHAMPION	2,500 BDT
1ST RUNNERS-UP	1,500 BDT
2ND RUNNERS-UP	1,000 BDT

Total prize pool of 5,000 BDT across the top three participants.

Before the sprint

EVENT SCHEDULE

Registration deadline

7 September 2026

Event date

11 September 2026

Single online round, 5:00

PM – 11:00 PM

Contest window

6 hours

One continuous sitting

ABOUT REGISTRATION

Registration fee **No registration fee**

- Open to all current AUST students, any department.
- Cross-department teams are allowed.
- If anyone makes a mistake during registration, they must inform the organizers about cancelling that registration before registering again.

TEAM REQUIREMENTS

1–3 members per team

- A team consists of 1–3 members.
- Cross-department teams are allowed to participate.

The 6-phase, 6-hour sprint

1	Understand the Problem A one-page brief: problem, users, goals, limits	00:00 – 00:40	40 min
2	Research Your Users Notes on what you learned from the scenario	00:40 – 01:20	40 min
3	Plan the Structure Sitemap or flow diagram of the app's main sections	01:20 – 02:10	50 min
4	Design the Screens Finished-looking screens for the whole main journey	02:10 – 03:40	90 min
5	Build a Clean Design File Tidy design file that resizes cleanly	03:40 – 04:50	70 min
6	Prototype & Handoff Clickable prototype link	04:50 – 05:40	50 min
—	Time to Submit Upload your final package to the submission form	05:40 – 06:00	20 min

Understand & research

1 Understand the Problem

00:00 – 00:40 · 40 MIN

Turn the released theme into a clear problem statement before you touch a single screen.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLE

- A one-page brief: the problem, who it is for, the goals, and the limits
- 3–5 user stories (“As a [user], I want [goal], so that [benefit]”), each with 1–2 ways to tell it is done
- 1–2 rough user profiles — you will check these in Phase 2, so they need not be final

Tools: Optional. ChatGPT, Claude, or a plain notebook all work equally well here.

Tip. This step is graded on its own. A vague brief costs you time in every phase after it.

2 Research Your Users

00:40 – 01:20 · 40 MIN

Do your research using the scenario released with the theme. There are no real users to interview in a timed contest, so the scenario stands in for them.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLE

- A short write-up of what you learned from the scenario — done however you like
- An updated user profile — change your Phase 1 guess based on what the scenario shows
- 3–5 main problems or insights you found in it

How this works. A written scenario is released at the start of Phase 2. Work through it yourselves, with or without AI, inside the 40 minutes.

Tip. Treat it as real information, not filler — judges will check that your later decisions come from it.

Plan & design

3 Plan the Structure

01:20 – 02:10 · 50 MIN

Structure the product before you touch visual design.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLE

- A sitemap or flow diagram of the app's main sections
- Rough wireframes (photos of hand sketches are fine) for the 3–5 main screens in your user stories

Tools: Optional — Relume, Google Stitch, Figma low-fi frames, or pen and paper.

Tip. Judges want wireframes that clearly match a user story, not pretty ones.

4 Design the Screens

02:10 – 03:40 · 90 MIN

Turn your structure into a real, full-colour flow.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLE

- Finished-looking screens for the whole main journey from Phases 1–3, not just a home screen
- A short note: how does each screen serve a user story or fix a problem from Phase 2?

Tools: Optional — Figma, Adobe XD, Flowstep AI, or any design tool you're comfortable with.

Tip. This is the single most heavily weighted phase. Protect this time block; don't let Phase 1–3 run long into it.

Tidy up & hand off

5 Build a Clean Design File

03:40 – 04:50 · 70 MIN

Make your file tidy enough for a developer to pick up.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLE

- A final design file that uses auto-layout so it resizes cleanly
- A written-down colour palette and font set, with a short reason for each choice
- Real text in every screen — no lorem ipsum — and the theme's logo used
- Basic accessibility notes: colour contrast, alt text, and any other accessibility choices you made

Tools: Optional — Figma plus plugins, or Adobe XD.

Tip. This is what separates a student file from a portfolio-ready one. Make your existing screens consistent instead of adding new ones.

6 Prototype & Handoff

04:50 – 05:40 · 50 MIN

Package your work the way a designer hands it to a developer or a client.

REQUIRED DELIVERABLE

- A clickable prototype link (Figma prototype, Claude Artifacts, or similar)
- A one-page handoff note: main flows, open questions, and what a developer needs to know

Tip. A prototype that does not click through end to end counts as incomplete, even if the screens look great.

05:40 – 06:00 · Time to submit — 20 min. Late uploads are not accepted.

AI is optional, your thinking is not

AI tools are optional at every phase, including Phase 2. Teams are free to complete the entire sprint with traditional tools — pen and paper, Figma alone, manual research notes — if they prefer.

The Phase 2 scenario stands in for the real users you would normally talk to. How you work through it is up to you.

If you use AI, we still expect to see your own thinking. Your prompts, edits, and decisions are what get judged — not the raw output of a tool.

SUGGESTED, NEVER REQUIRED

Phase 1	ChatGPT, Claude, or a plain notebook
Phase 2	Any AI, or your own notes
Phase 3	Relume, Google Stitch, Figma low-fi, pen and paper
Phase 4	Figma, Adobe XD, Flowstep AI
Phase 5	Figma plus plugins, or Adobe XD
Phase 6	Figma prototyping, Claude Artifacts

One package, six phases

Submit one package containing the outputs of all six phases through the official submission form before the end of the buffer window. **Late uploads are not accepted.**

Phase 1	Brief document + user stories + rough user profiles
Phase 2	Research notes from the scenario + updated user profile + list of problems
Phase 3	Sitemap + rough wireframes (images or PDF)
Phase 4	Finished screens for the whole main journey + your note
Phase 5	Final Figma (or Adobe XD) file link, view access enabled
Phase 6	Clickable prototype link + one-page handoff note

How you are scored

Brief & User Stories Is the problem clear? Are the user stories specific and checkable?	10%
Research & User Profile Did you really use the scenario? Did your user profile and problem list change from Phase 1 to 2?	15%
Structure & Wireframes Do the sitemap and wireframes clearly match the user stories?	15%
Screen Design How good the screens look, and whether the whole journey is covered — not one hero screen.	25%
Design File Quality Auto-layout, consistent colours and fonts, real text, no placeholders.	15%
Prototype & Handoff Does the prototype click through end to end? Can someone else use your handoff note?	10%
Accessibility & Usability Contrast, alt text, and other accessibility choices are written down, not just claimed.	10%

The hard lines

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| 01 | The theme/brief is released at the start of the contest window and must be followed. |
| 02 | All work must be original and produced by the registered team within the contest window — no pre-made templates from before the event. |
| 03 | AI is allowed under the Tools Policy, but you must be able to explain any design decision if a judge asks. |
| 04 | Plagiarism or use of someone else's uncredited work results in disqualification . |
| 05 | Entries must comply with the theme and guidelines set by the organizers. |

For queries

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Organizers reserve the right to make final decisions and alter rules at any point during the event.

